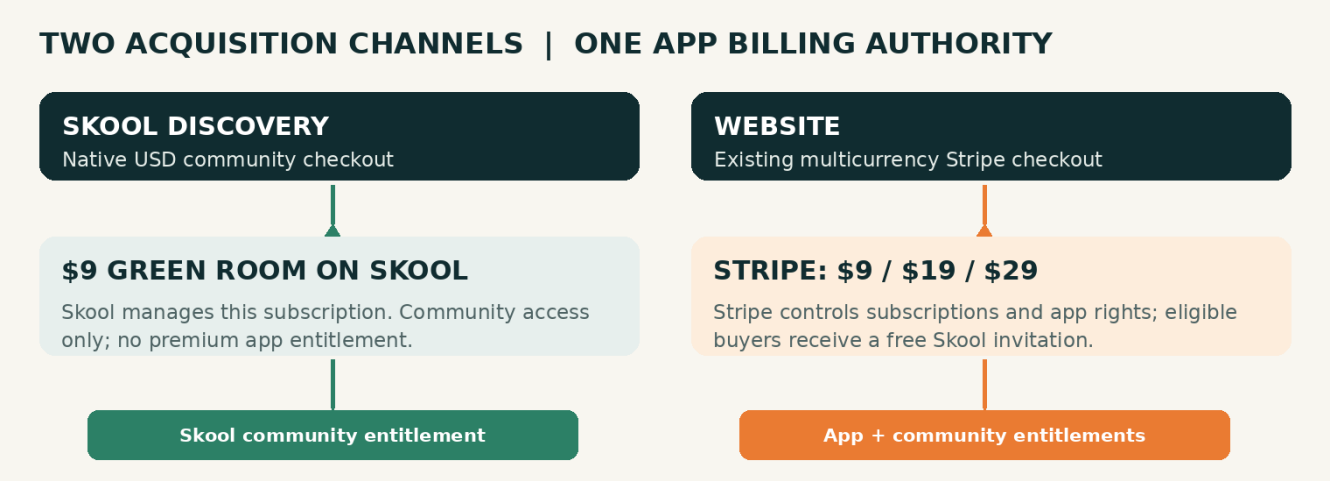
BOARD DECISION PAPER • RESEARCH-BASED RECOMMENDATION

# Grow through Skool. Keep the app on Stripe.

A controlled hybrid acquisition model for The Actors Copilot




## Executive decision

Offer native Skool Green Room subscriptions ($9/month, $90/year) as a dedicated community-acquisition channel. Retain Stripe as the billing and app-entitlement authority for Economy and Business, including the established USD, GBP and EUR website checkouts.

**Key constraint.** Skool does not support the external subscription lifecycle notifications or automated paid-to-free conversion required for a one-step cross-platform transfer. A verified administrator handoff is therefore required by Skool's current integration and membership procedures; it is not a limitation of Stripe's billing capabilities.

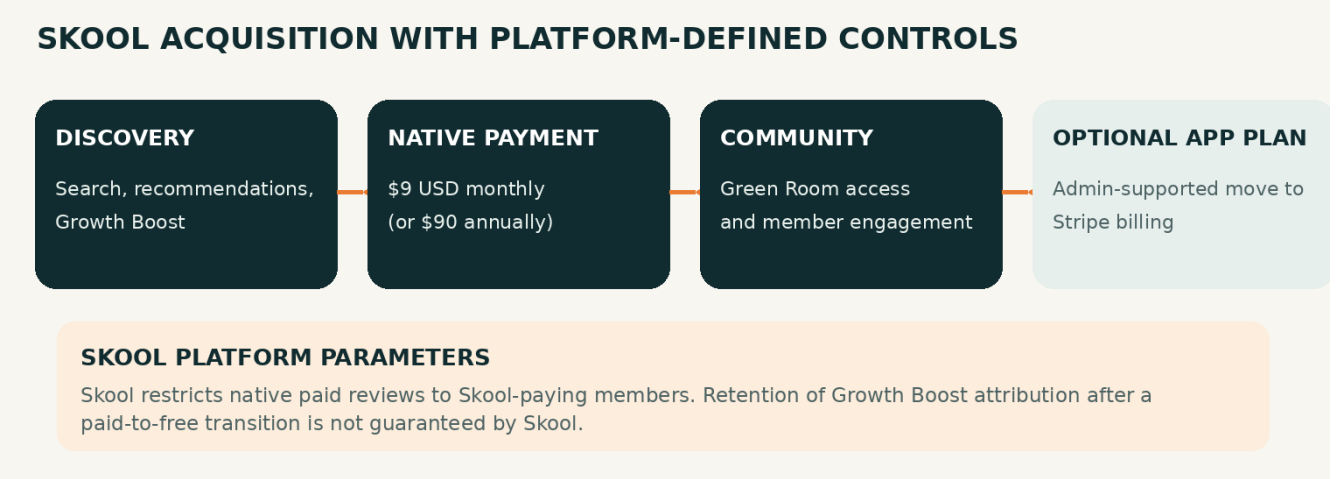
| DECISION | GO / NO-GO | WHY |
|---|---|---|
| Native Green Room only | GO, with controls | Skool-native discovery and reviews; no app permissions to synchronize |
| Economy / Business on Stripe | GO | Documented subscription events and multi-currency control |
| Native Skool Economy / Business | NO-GO | Missing supported app entitlement lifecycle signals |
| Coupon-assisted migration | CONDITIONAL GO | Required by Skool cancellation and invitation capabilities |

Prepared for Tracey Collis and the implementation team. Source-based assessment; not confirmation of production readiness or a commitment to automated Skool subscription state synchronization.

01 / COMMERCIAL RATIONALE

# Why native Skool billing still matters

Skool native billing can support community acquisition while app subscriptions retain their existing payment architecture.




## Documented advantages

- A native paid Green Room member can contribute to the paid-member review ecosystem; externally paying free-invited members cannot leave these native paid-member reviews. [S3]
- Growth Boost may surface the community in search, recommendations and Skool-run advertising; Skool charges a 30% recurring commission on the members it acquires. [S1, S2]
- Skool lists off-platform payments as a Discovery ranking penalty. The impact on a mixed-payment community is not quantified. [S4]
- Native subscriptions are USD-only. Fixed GBP and EUR offers must therefore continue through Stripe. [S2]

## Commercial interpretation

The recommended structure supports a native $9 Skool offer for community acquisition, while preserving an authoritative, auditable Stripe subscription lifecycle for premium app features. Growth Boost may provide incremental acquisition; visibility, reviews, conversion and volume remain subject to Skool policies and performance.

**Important qualification.** Skool does not provide a supported guarantee of Growth Boost attribution or Discovery treatment after a member transitions from native paid billing to free invited access. We therefore do not assume continued attribution in the commercial model.

02 / FEASIBILITY

# Decision matrix

Production assessment rule: capabilities without explicit official support are classified NOT SUPPORTED and excluded from the implementation baseline.

### ARCHITECTURE DECISION MATRIX

| OPTION | APP STATE | USD / GBP / EUR | SKOOL GROWTH | VERDICT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Stripe only** | SUPPORTED | YES | LIMITED | **Viable; Skool-native reach limited** |
| **Skool only** | NOT SUPPORTED | USD ONLY | POTENTIAL | **No-go** |
| **Full dual billing** | NOT SUPPORTED | SPLIT | POTENTIAL | **No-go for app plans** |
| **Limited hybrid** | SUPPORTED* | YES / USD | POTENTIAL | **RECOMMENDED WITH CONTROLS** |

* Community-only native subscriptions. Skool does not support automatic cross-platform transfer; an administrator-led handoff is required.

## Why the limited hybrid is materially different

Native Skool billing is limited to community-only access because external tier-change, cancellation and subscription-state interfaces are NOT SUPPORTED by Skool's official integration. Premium app entitlements instead use Stripe's supported subscription events and the existing app backend.

## Non-negotiable design principles

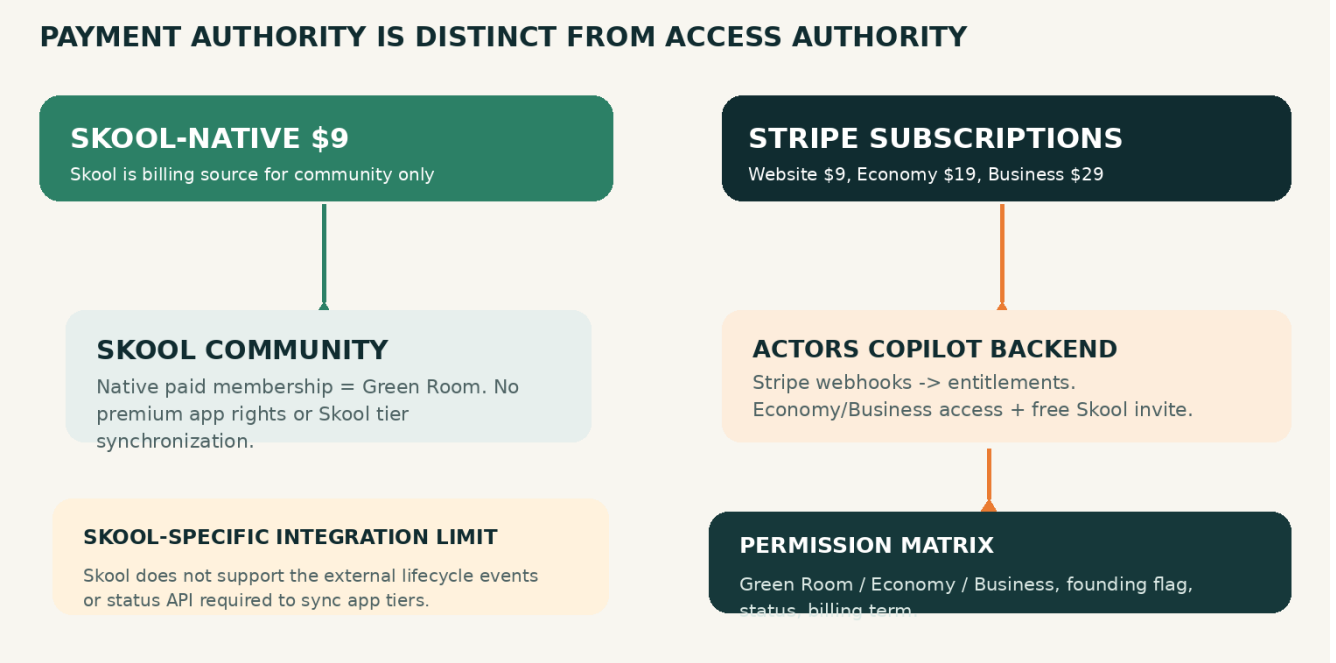
- Only one community exists: every eligible customer sees the same Green Room content.
- Maintain Economy and Business app billing in Stripe: Skool does not support the external lifecycle integration these plans require.
- State clearly that Skool does not support automated cross-platform cancellation or paid-to-free conversion through its official integration.
- No shared public founding-member or migration coupon; eligibility and use must be constrained.
- Validate and document the Skool-required administrative transition before representing the cross-platform journey as complete.

Supported* means Stripe-managed app entitlements plus an administrator-led handoff because Skool does not support subscription-change or paid-to-free conversion interfaces for external systems.

03 / SYSTEMS DESIGN

# Two billing authorities, separate scopes

Define discrete platform responsibilities in accordance with the interfaces each provider officially supports.



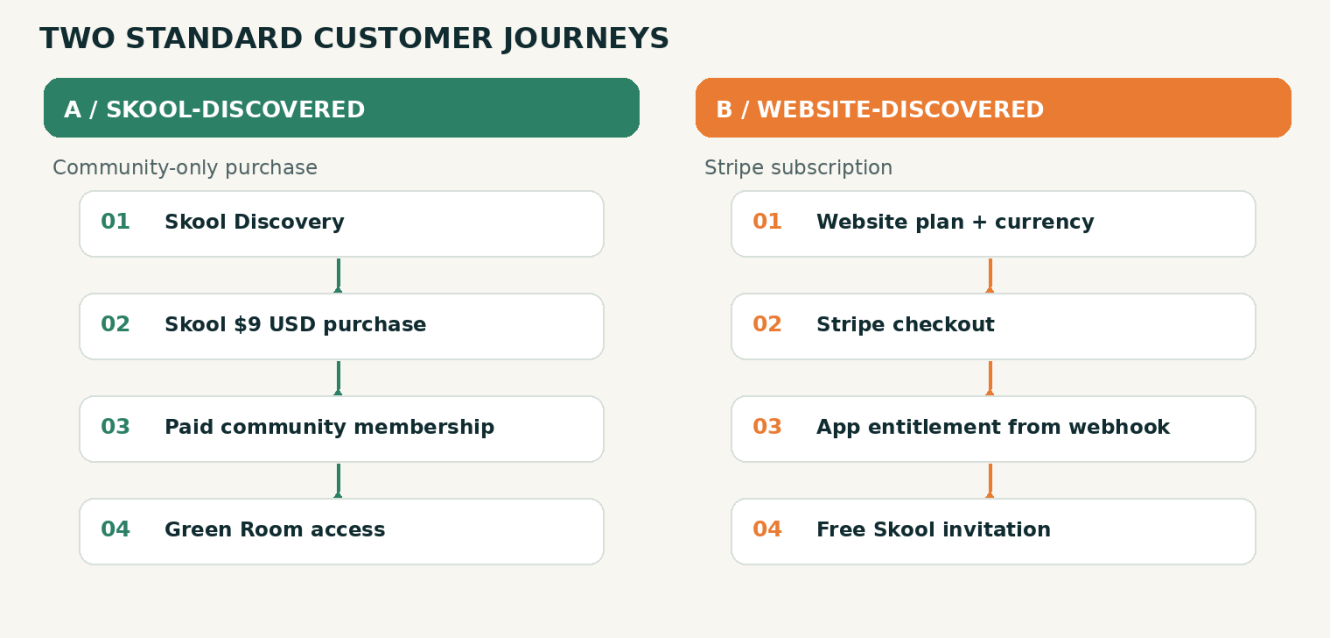

| SOURCE | WHAT IT CONTROLS | WHAT IT MUST NOT CONTROL |
|---|---|---|
| Skool native billing | Community membership purchased on Skool ($9 USD / $90 USD) | Economy or Business app permissions |
| Stripe billing | Website Green Room; Economy and Business; currencies; founders; trials | Native Skool renewal or cancellation state |
| Actors Copilot backend | Stripe-derived plan entitlements and account access | Invented Skool subscription state |
| Skool invitations | Free community admission for qualified Stripe customers | Subscription identity or price on Stripe |

**Identity handling.** Store app account ID, Stripe customer/subscription IDs, member email, the reported Skool account email and a verified link or operator note when migration occurs. Email equality alone is not strong proof of the same account. Do not claim Skool account merging is supported. [S10]

04 / STANDARD JOURNEYS

# What customers should experience

The model preserves simple purchase journeys for customers who remain in their original billing channel.




## Website Stripe purchase

After a confirmed Economy or Business checkout, the customer should see a thank-you page, receive payment confirmation, obtain the proper app features and receive a free Green Room invitation if not already a member. The existing Stripe webhook/invitation integration is the implementation starting point; its end-to-end reliability still needs testing.

## Skool-native community purchase

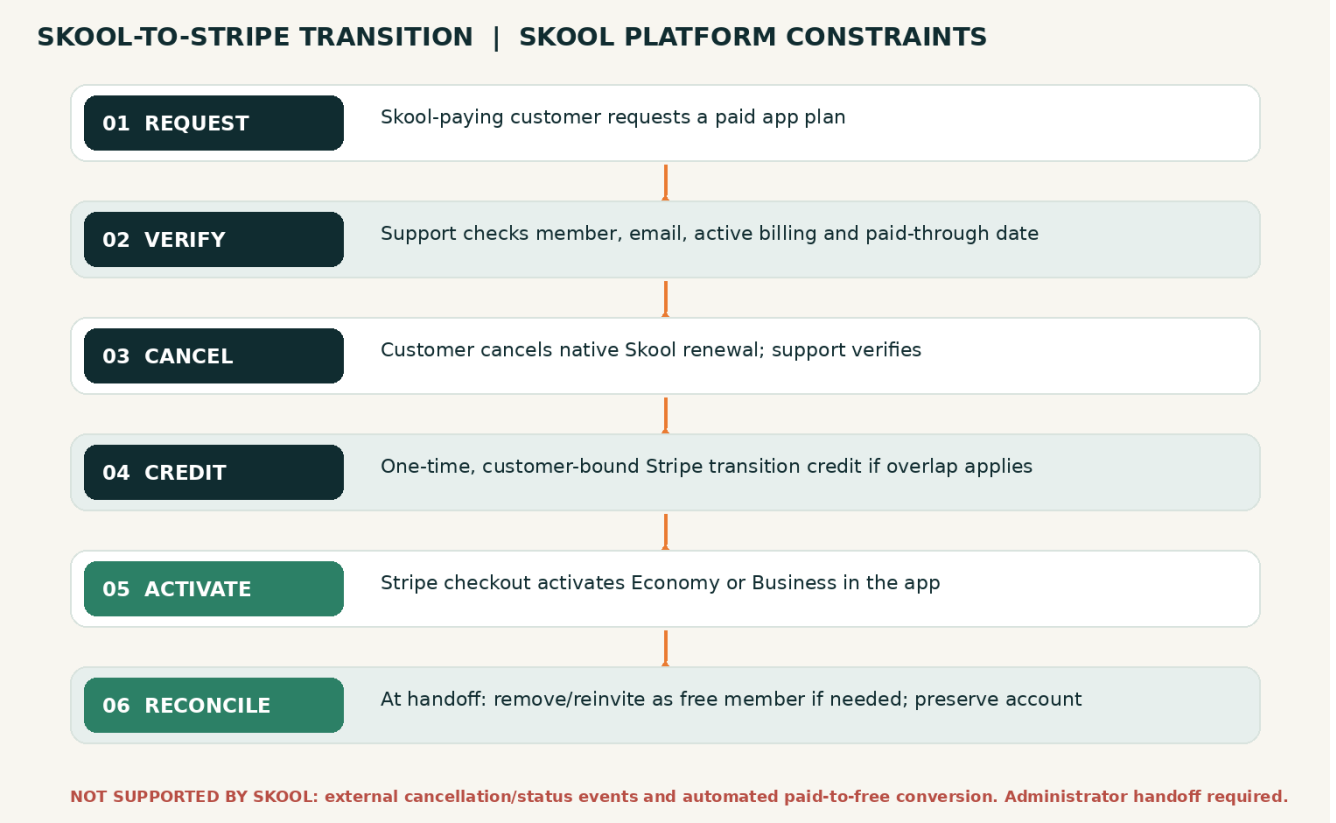
Skool collects the $9 USD community subscription and manages Green Room access within Skool. No premium app entitlement depends on native Skool billing, because Skool does not support the external lifecycle events needed for app authorization.

**Existing subscribers.** For an existing Skool-paying member, the required handoff must be completed before treating a Stripe app purchase as a replacement subscription. Existing free-invited website subscribers must not be offered an unnecessary second paid Skool membership.

05 / SKOOL-REQUIRED HANDOFF

# Coupon-assisted Skool → Stripe transition

Skool does not support an automated paid-to-free conversion API or the external subscription-state events needed for direct migration. The process therefore follows administrator-controlled Skool procedures.




## Two transition schedules under Skool billing rules

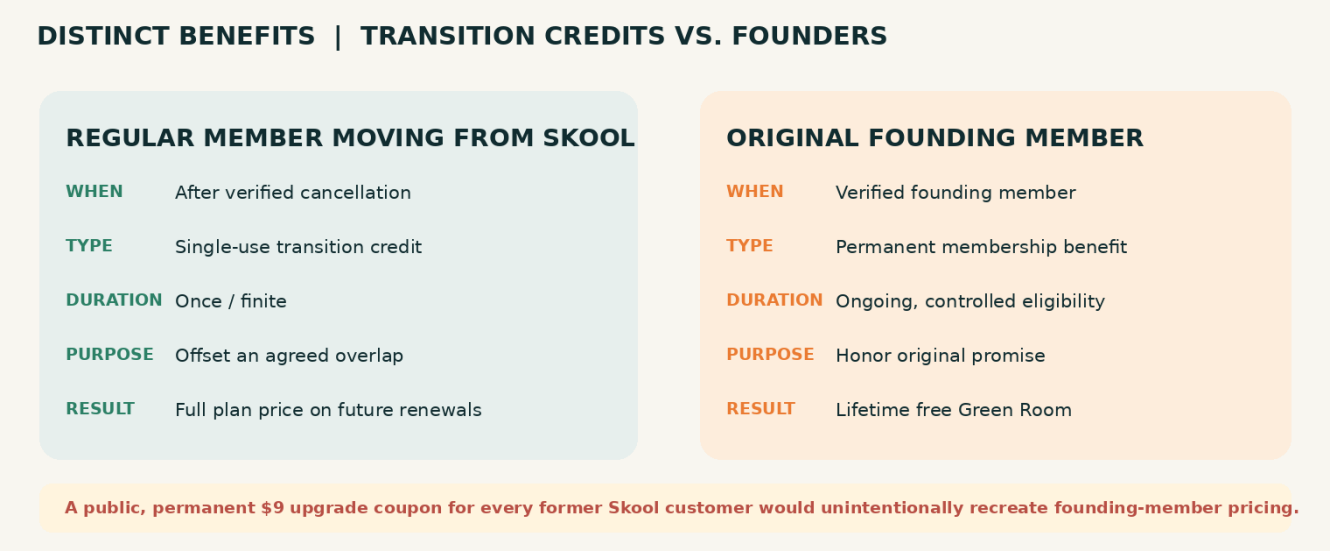
| PATH | PROCESS | SKOOL-SPECIFIC CONDITION |
|---|---|---|
| A. End-of-term | Cancel native renewal; start Stripe app access near the Skool paid-through date; reconcile membership. | Skool membership remains paid through term; admin confirmation is needed. |
| B. Immediate | Cancel Skool renewal; start Stripe app plan now; apply an approved one-time overlap credit. | Skool cancellation is not immediate; paid-to-free re-invitation requires admin handling. |

**Skool platform constraint.** Skool retains canceled paid memberships through the paid period. Under Subscription or Tiers pricing, Skool documents an administrator removal and reinvitation to convert paid access to free invited access; the user must accept the invitation. Skool describes progress as recoverable upon rejoining. These are native Skool operating constraints, not Stripe integration defects. [S5, S6]

06 / DISCOUNT GOVERNANCE

# One-time transition credit vs. lifetime founder entitlement

Founding-member entitlements and short-term transition credits serve separate purposes and require distinct, controlled Stripe configurations.




## Practical Stripe configuration

- Regular migration: a customer-bound, single-redemption, time-limited promotion code with a one-time coupon. Amount should reflect the approved overlap policy and verified remaining paid period. [S8, S9]
- Founders: verify permanent eligibility against a founder registry; maintain free Skool membership; use an appropriately scoped recurring Stripe discount where the founder promise applies. [S2, S8]
- Make currency explicit. A USD amount-off coupon is not automatically an equivalent GBP or EUR discount; use currency-specific values/configuration. [S8]
- Annual Skool migration: do not assume the unused value equals one $9 monthly payment. Check the remaining prepaid annual period and establish a written credit/refund policy.
- Do not stack migration incentives with founding discounts or promotional trials without an explicit business rule. Verify how the current 14-day app trial affects the first invoice.

**Example, not a default policy.** A regular $9 Skool member moving to $19 Economy might receive up to $9 off the first Stripe invoice if one full month of Skool billing overlap is accepted and verified; subsequent Economy renewals remain $19. A founder may qualify for $9 off every monthly Economy invoice instead.

07 / COMMERCIAL CONFIGURATION

# Pricing integrity and founding-member commitments

Use Tracey's latest fixed-currency pricing, not earlier Stripe links that still display different GBP/EUR values.

## Approved public prices supplied by Tracey

| PRODUCT | USD / MONTH | GBP / MONTH | EUR / MONTH | USD / YEAR | GBP / YEAR | EUR / YEAR |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Green Room | $9 | £7 | €8 | $90 | £70 | €80 |
| Economy | $19 | £14 | €17 | $190 | £140 | €170 |
| Business | $29 | £22 | €26 | $290 | £220 | €260 |

Skool native billing can offer Green Room only in USD. Stripe website prices can use fixed approved USD/GBP/EUR amounts.

## Founding-member prices, derived from the promised Green Room-value discount

| APP SUBSCRIPTION | USD / MONTH | GBP / MONTH | EUR / MONTH | USD / YEAR | GBP / YEAR | EUR / YEAR |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Founder Economy | $10 | £7 | €9 | $100 | £70 | €90 |
| Founder Business | $20 | £15 | €18 | $200 | £150 | €180 |

Derived assumption requires Tracey's approval for GBP/EUR founder equivalencies. No founder payment is required for Green Room itself.

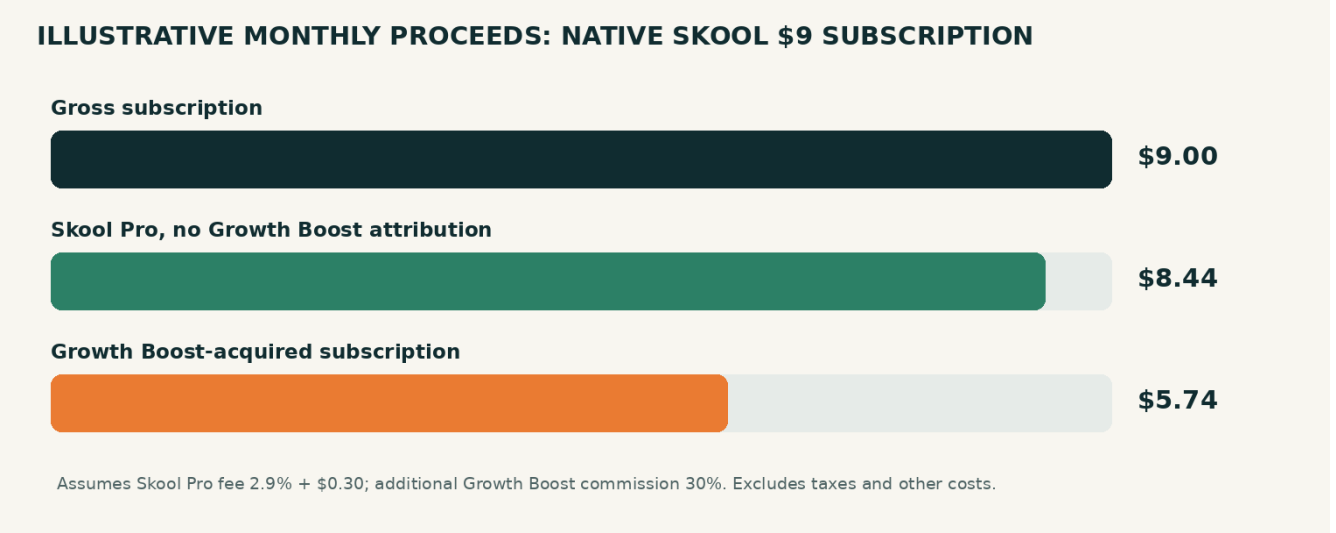
## Corrections before publish

- Earlier Green Room Stripe payment links were described as GBP £9 / EUR €9 monthly and £90 / €90 annual. They conflict with the newest approved £7/€8 and £70/€80. Verify and replace or reconfigure those links.
- "Two months free" on annual pricing means 10 months paid at monthly rates (about 16.7% off 12 months), not "20% off." Correct inaccurate UI labels.
- Check all Economy/Business monthly and annual Stripe Price IDs and supported currencies; earlier diagnostics reported missing annual price configuration.
- Keep the 200 founding members' free Skool entitlements independent of Stripe payment status.

08 / GROWTH ECONOMICS

# Cost of acquiring a native Skool subscriber

At $9/month, native community subscriptions can generate referral revenue, but Growth Boost commission is material.




## How to interpret the example

These estimates use Skool's published Pro processing fee (2.9% + $0.30) and, for a customer Skool brings, its additional 30% recurring Growth Boost commission. They are illustrative, exclude taxes and other costs, and should not be mistaken for a full unit-economics forecast. [S2, S4]

## Metrics worth tracking separately

| NATIVE SKOOL | WEBSITE STRIPE | MIGRATION QUALITY |
|---|---|---|
| Discovery views and paid joins | Visits → paid conversion | % upgrades verified before checkout |
| Skool-attributed subscribers | Monthly/annual churn | Time to free re-invite |
| Native review eligibility | Net revenue / renewal | Duplicate-charge incidents |
| Retention and revenue net of fees | EUR/GBP pricing conversion | Coupon redemption and abuse rate |

**Decision lens.** The 30% Growth Boost cost may be worthwhile if it attracts incremental customers, but there is no documented guarantee of traffic or sales. Likewise, the effect of later free-invited migrations on ongoing Discovery performance is not quantified.

09 / RISKS

# Risk register and operating safeguards

Stripe provides supported subscription lifecycle events for app billing. Skool does not support programmatic paid-to-free conversion or external-member offboarding, so those Skool-specific steps require administrator action.

| RISK | SEVERITY | CONTROL / ACCOUNTABLE OWNER |
|---|---|---|
| Skool + Stripe charge overlap | HIGH | Customer-success verifies cancellation and paid-through date; migration credit approved before checkout. |
| Member removed from Skool during conversion | HIGH | Admin-managed removal/re-invitation; use existing account; clear status updates to customer. |
| Coupon shared or reused | HIGH | Stripe customer-bound / single-use codes, expiration and redemption audit. |
| Founder loses lifetime access | CRITICAL | Permanent founder flag; never remove founder during app offboarding. |
| Currency or annual-price mismatch | HIGH | Product-by-product Stripe test before launch; annual “two months free” copy. |
| Website buyer canceled; Skool stays active | MEDIUM | Stripe event → offboarding task → verified admin action, founders excluded. |
| Discovery/Boost expectations unmet | MEDIUM | Track Skool-only ROI; no acquisition forecast without real cohort data. |
| Duplicate identity / account | MEDIUM | Verification step; do not use email match as proof of account ownership. |

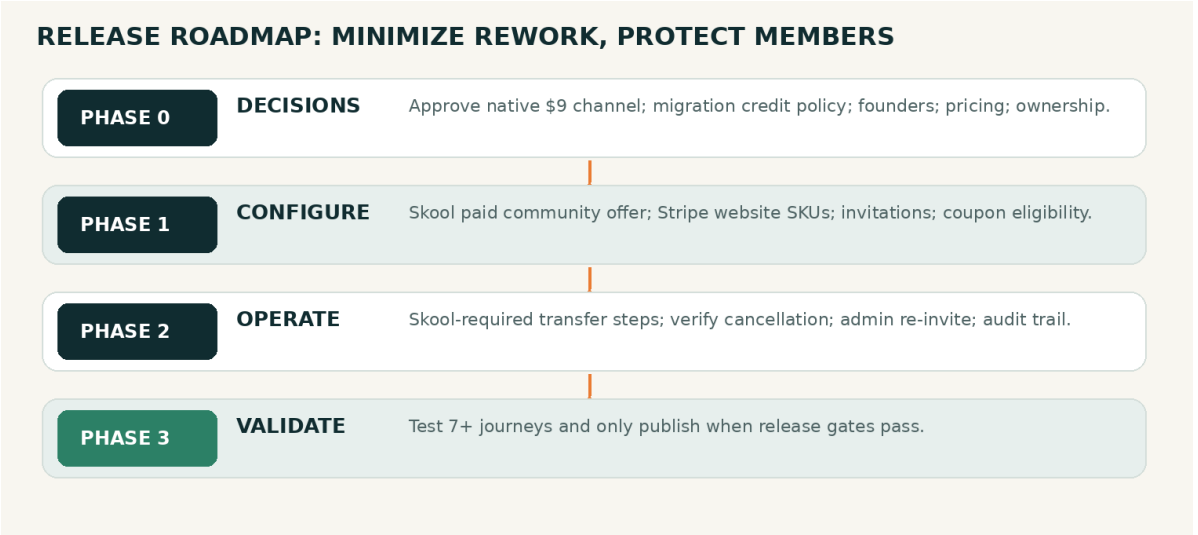
## Explicit product and support promises

- Present Skool-to-Stripe as a verified transition request: Skool does not support a one-click cross-platform subscription conversion.
- Show the customer what they will pay now, when their native Skool renewal ends and whether a transition credit applies.
- Make it clear that free community access continues only while a qualifying Stripe subscription or lifetime founder entitlement is active.
- Clearly state that automated external member removal and full tier-change synchronization are NOT SUPPORTED by Skool's official integration.

10 / DELIVERY PLAN

# Phased implementation and release gates

Implement native community acquisition without depending on subscription-event or membership-management interfaces NOT SUPPORTED by Skool.




## Minimum acceptance tests

| TEST JOURNEY | MUST PASS |
|---|---|
| Native Skool $9 monthly and $90 annual | Correct charge, membership and acquisition tracking. |
| Website Green Room (3 currencies) | Approved prices and verified invitation. |
| Website Economy and Business | Correct plan, trial policy, currency, entitlement and email. |
| Monthly Skool → Stripe migration | Skool cancellation verified; approved credit; admin-confirmed free re-invite. |
| Annual Skool → Stripe migration | Remaining prepaid Skool term reconciled under an approved credit policy. |
| Founding member Economy → cancel | Founder never loses lifetime Green Room access. |
| Stripe downgrade / cancellation | App entitlements and Skool administrator-led offboarding follow the agreed effective date. |
| Duplicate signup / mismatched email | No unverified account merge or second unintentional charge. |

## Suggested accountable owners — to be confirmed

| LEAD | PROPOSED RESPONSIBILITY |
|---|---|
| Tracey | Approve prices, founding policy, credits and customer-facing migration language. |
| Marcos | Configure native Skool offer and Stripe prices/discounts; verify checkouts. |
| Caio / development | Implement and test Stripe entitlement rules, identities and event handling. |
| Raquel | Align website pricing, selectors, checkout destinations and confirmation journey. |
| Community operations | Verify Skool cancellations; coordinate free re-invites and offboarding. |

11 / FINAL DECISION

# Management recommendation and open approvals

A defined commercial model that preserves native Skool acquisition and Stripe app billing within each platform's documented operational capabilities.

## Approve subject to Skool-required administrative procedures

- Skool-native Green Room subscription for direct Skool discovery, USD-only ($9/month; $90/year).
- Continue Stripe billing for all website purchases and all Economy/Business app subscriptions.
- Keep one shared Green Room and invite qualifying Stripe subscribers free of an additional Skool charge.
- Use customer-verified, one-time Stripe credits for normal Skool-to-app migration when there is paid overlap.
- Give founders distinct recurring entitlements and controlled discounts; never disturb lifetime free access.

## Do not approve

- Economy/Business subscription tiers paid through Skool and synchronized to the app.
- A promise of automatic Skool-to-Stripe upgrades or cancellations: these workflows are NOT SUPPORTED by Skool's official integration.
- Unrestricted public coupons, unlimited credits for former Skool members, or discount stacking without policy.
- A production launch with unverified annual prices, mixed currencies or unresolved member-invitation/offboarding handling.

## Four sign-offs requested from Tracey

| DECISION | NEEDED APPROVAL |
|---|---|
| Product ownership | Skool native = Green Room only; Stripe = all app subscriptions. |
| Migration policy | End-of-term vs immediate credit; annual prepaid-value treatment. |
| Founder pricing | Final GBP/EUR founding equivalents and eligibility list. |
| Launch operations | Skool-required admin conversion and offboarding, with assigned ownership. |

**BOTTOM LINE: Preserve Skool-native customer acquisition and Stripe-managed app entitlements. The administrator-led migration is required because Skool does not support the necessary cross-platform subscription and paid-to-free conversion interfaces.**

APPENDIX / SOURCE NOTES

# Documentation reviewed

Official sources prioritized. Reviewed 14 October 2026. Capabilities without explicit official support are classified NOT SUPPORTED.

**[S1] Skool — Traffic Sources & Growth Boost**
https://help.skool.com/article/226-traffic-sources

**[S2] Skool — Payments FAQs**
https://help.skool.com/article/86-subscriptions-faq

**[S3] Skool — How do reviews work?**
https://help.skool.com/article/239-how-do-reviews-work-on-skool

**[S4] Skool — Discovery FAQs**
https://help.skool.com/article/153-discovery-faqs

**[S5] Skool — How to cancel a paid membership**
https://help.skool.com/article/99-how-to-cancel-my-subscription-to-a-community

**[S6] Skool — How to make paid member free**
https://help.skool.com/article/242-how-to-make-paid-member-free

**[S7] Skool — Invite members to community**
https://help.skool.com/article/14-how-do-i-invite-members-to-my-community

**[S8] Stripe — Create a coupon**
https://docs.stripe.com/api/coupons/create

**[S9] Stripe — Create a promotion code**
https://docs.stripe.com/api/promotion_codes/create

**[S10] Skool — Multiple accounts cannot merge**
https://help.skool.com/article/222-how-to-manage-multiple-skool-accounts

**[S11] Skool — Official Zapier integration**
https://help.skool.com/article/56-zapier-integration

**[S12] Skool — New paid member trigger example**
https://help.skool.com/article/162-zapier-new-paid-member-info-to-crm

**[S13] Skool — Pricing models**
https://help.skool.com/article/215-how-to-setup-pricing-for-the-group

## Methodology and limitations

Evidence standard: for this production-feasibility assessment, any capability absent from officially supported documentation is classified NOT SUPPORTED; this describes the integration commitment available for production planning, not a claim that no internal or future implementation could ever exist. The assessment uses published Skool and Stripe references, team-provided project context and labeled assumptions. Skool-specific limitations arise from Skool's supported interface and membership procedures, not Stripe. Live Stripe/Skool accounts, current source code and deployed Zapier workflows were not independently inspected. Pricing links require transactional verification; Growth Boost and Discovery results are not guaranteed. Unofficial Skool APIs are excluded from production entitlement authorization.